Grade 12 English Grammar: Reference & Practice
Comprehensive rules, examples, and 15–30 practice questions per topic.

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Question Tags

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. A question tag is a short question added to the end of a statement. It repeats the auxiliary verb (or 'do/does/did' if necessary) and the subject.
2. If the main clause is positive, the tag is usually negative; if the main clause is negative, the tag is usually positive.
3. Use 'aren't' with plural 'be' in present continuous (e.g., 'They are playing, aren't they?').
4. With modal verbs, repeat the modal (can, should, must, etc.) in the tag ('You can swim, can't you?'). 5. If the main clause has no auxiliary, use 'do/does/did' in the correct tense ('She likes tea, doesn't she?').

Examples:

- She can swim, can't she?
- They aren't coming, are they?
- You have finished your homework, haven't you?
- He will be here, won't he?

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. You like coffee, _____?
2. She hasn't arrived yet, _____?
3. They will join us, _____?
4. He can drive, _____?
5. We aren't late, _____?
6. I am right, _____?
7. She does her homework, _____?
8. Nobody called, _____?
9. Everyone knows that, _____?
10. Let's go, _____?
11. You'd prefer tea, _____?

12. He used to smoke, _____?
13. She had left, _____?
14. They could help, _____?
15. No one answered, _____?
16. She ought to come, _____?
17. It isn't raining, _____?
18. You have been there before, _____?
19. We should start, _____?
20. Nobody ever helps, _____?

Answers (Suggested):

1. don't you?
2. has she?
3. won't they?
4. can't he?
5. are we?6. aren't I?
7. doesn't she?
8. did they?
9. don't they?10. shall we?
11. wouldn't you?
12. didn't he?
13. hadn't she?
14. couldn't they?
15. did they?
16. oughtn't she?
17. is it?
18. haven't you?
19. shouldn't we?

20. do they?

Modal Verbs

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Modal verbs (can, could, may, might, must, shall, should, will, would, ought to) express ability, permission, possibility, obligation, advice, or future.
2. Models are followed by the base form of the verb (without 'to'), except 'ought to'.
3. Modals do not take '-s' in the third person singular and have no infinitive or participle forms.
4. Use 'could' as past of 'can' for ability or polite requests; 'might' and 'may' for possibility; 'must' for strong obligation or logical deduction.

Examples:

- She can speak three languages.
- You should finish your work on time.
- May I borrow your pen?
- They must be at home by now (logical deduction).

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. I _____ (ability) lift this box. (can)
2. _____ I borrow your pen? (permission)
3. You _____ study harder for the exam. (advice)
4. He _____ be the thief — he was nowhere near. (deduction)
5. When I was young I _____ run fast. (past ability)
6. You _____ smoke here — it's a no-smoking area. (prohibition)
7. She _____ have taken the wrong train. (possibility)
8. _____ we leave now? (request/suggestion)
9. He said he _____ help us tomorrow. (future possibility)
10. You _____ to apologize for that. (advice, use 'ought')
11. They _____ finish by Friday. (probability)
12. I _____ be mistaken. (polite possibility)

13. You _____ see a doctor if it continues. (advice)
14. She _____ have known — she wasn't there. (logical deduction about past)
15. He _____ speak French when he was a child. (ability past)
16. _____ you help me with this? (polite request)
17. It _____ rain tomorrow. (weak possibility)
18. You _____ not ignore the instructions. (obligation)
19. He _____ have taken the bus. (past deduction)
20. They _____ book tickets in advance. (recommendation)

Answers (Suggested):

1. can
2. May
3. should
4. can't / couldn't
5. could
6. mustn't
7. might / could
8. Shall
9. would / will
10. ought
11. should / ought to
12. may / might
13. should
14. can't / couldn't
15. could
16. Could
17. may / might

18. must
19. must
20. should

Determiners & Quantifiers

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Determiners (a, an, the, this, that, these, those) introduce nouns and give information about definiteness and reference.
2. Quantifiers (few, a few, little, a little, many, much, some, any, all, both, each, every) express quantity. Note countable vs uncountable nouns.
3. 'Few' vs 'a few' — 'few' implies almost none (negative), 'a few' implies some (positive). Similarly 'little' vs 'a little'.
4. Use 'some' in positive sentences and offers; 'any' in negatives and questions (exceptions exist).

'Each' and 'every' differ: 'each' views individually, 'every' as a whole group.

Examples:

- She has many friends.
- I need a pencil.
- There isn't much milk in the fridge.
- Each student must submit the form.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. There isn’t _____ milk in the fridge. (much)
2. _____ student must submit the form. (every/each)
3. We saw _____ interesting movies. (some/many)
4. I have _____ apples. (a few)
5. She has _____ patience for such things. (little/a little)
6. Do you have _____ sugar? (any)
7. He gave me _____ advice. (some)
8. _____ of the problems are solved. (all/both)
9. I have _____ money left. (little/few)
10. There are _____ chairs in the room. (many)
11. She has _____ books on the shelf. (a lot of)

12. I didn't buy _____ fruit today. (any)
13. They have _____ time to finish. (enough)
14. _____ student should bring their ID. (each/every)
15. He ate _____ of the cake. (all)
16. I only have _____ coins. (a few)
17. There is _____ water in the bottle. (some)
18. _____ two contestants advanced. (both)
19. We need _____ sugar to make the cake. (some/much)
20. I have _____ information on that topic. (little/much)

Answers (Suggested):

1. much
2. Each / Every
3. some / many
4. a few
5. little / a little
6. any
7. some
8. All / Both
9. little
10. many
11. a lot of / many
12. any
13. enough
14. Each / Every
15. all
16. a few
17. some

18. Both
19. some / much
20. little / much

Subject–Verb Agreement

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. The verb must agree with its subject in number (singular/plural) and person (1st/2nd/3rd).
2. Ignore phrases between subject and verb (e.g., 'The list of items is on the table.' — subject 'list' is singular).
3. With compound subjects joined by 'and' use a plural verb; joined by 'or/nor' the verb agrees with the nearer subject.
4. Collective nouns may take singular or plural depending on meaning (group as a unit vs. individuals).
5. Indefinite pronouns (everyone, someone, nobody) are usually singular.

Examples:

- The dog barks. (singular)
- The dogs bark. (plural)
- Either the teacher or the students are responsible. (verb agrees with nearer noun)
- Everyone is here. (indefinite pronoun — singular)

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. The list of items _____ on the table. (be)
2. Either the boy or his friends _____ coming. (be)
3. The team _____ winning the match. (is/are - depending on meaning)
4. Each of the girls _____ a book. (have)
5. One of the students _____ absent. (be)
6. Neither the teacher nor the students _____ late. (be)
7. Ten kilometers _____ a long distance. (be)
8. My family _____ going to the festival. (is/are)
9. The news _____ surprising. (be)

10. Either John or Mary _____ responsible. (be)
11. Bread and butter _____ my favorite breakfast. (be)
12. The police _____ investigating the case. (is/are)
13. None of the answers _____ correct. (be)
14. The number of students _____ increasing. (be)
15. A pair of shoes _____ on the shelf. (be)
16. Each student and teacher _____ must register. (be)
17. Someone from the group _____ to call. (has/have)
18. Five years _____ a long time. (be)
19. Mathematics _____ an interesting subject. (be)
20. The committee _____ decided on the plan. (has/have)

1. is
2. are
3. is / are
4. has
5. is
6. are
7. is
8. is / are
9. is
10. is
11. is
12. are
13. is / are (depends)
14. is
15. is

Answers (Suggested):

16. must
17. has
18. is
19. is
20. has / have (context)

Connectives

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Connectives (conjunctions, linking words) join words, phrases, clauses, or sentences to show relationships: addition, contrast, cause & effect, sequence, purpose, condition.
2. Coordinate conjunctions: for, and, nor, but, or, yet, so (FANBOYS) — join equal elements.
3. Subordinating conjunctions: because, although, since, while, if, unless, when — introduce dependent clauses.
4. Conjunctive adverbs: however, therefore, moreover, consequently — connect independent clauses and need punctuation.

Examples:

- She studied hard, so she passed the exam.
- Although it rained, we finished the match.
- If you hurry, you'll catch the bus.
- He was late; nevertheless, he completed the task.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. Choose a connective: I was tired, _____ I finished the work. (so/because)
2. Fill: _____ she was ill, she attended. (although/because)
3. Combine: He missed the bus. He was late. (use: because)
4. Add a connector: She likes coffee _____ tea. (and/or)
5. Cause: I couldn't go _____ it rained. (because/although)
6. Contrast: She is rich, _____ she is unhappy. (however/because)
7. Condition: _____ you study, you will pass. (If/When)
8. Purpose: He saved money _____ buy a car. (to/so that)
9. Sequence: First _____ then _____. (do/combine)
10. Result: He worked hard, _____ he succeeded. (so/and)

Answers (Suggested):

11. Concession: _____ she tried, she couldn't win. (Although/Therefore)
12. Contrast with despite: _____ the rain, they went out. (Despite/Because)
13. Replacement: Use 'however' to show _____. (contrast)
14. Addition: He loves sports; _____, he plays football. (moreover)
15. Condition (negative): _____ you hurry, you'll miss the train. (Unless/If)
16. Time: Call me _____ you arrive. (when/if)
17. Comparison: She is smarter _____ him. (than)
18. Cause & effect: He failed _____ he didn't study. (because)
19. Consequence: It rained; _____, the match was canceled. (therefore)
20. Contrast: I wanted to go, _____ I couldn't. (but)

1. so
2. Although
3. He missed the bus because he was late.
4. and / or
5. because
6. however
7. If
8. to / so that
9. First do this, then do that.
10. so
11. Although
12. Despite
13. contrast

14. moreover
15. Unless
16. when
17. than
18. because
19. therefore
20. but

Answers (Suggested):

Wh-Questions

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Wh-questions start with words like who, what, where, when, why, which, whom, whose, how. They ask for specific information.
2. Word order: Wh-word + auxiliary + subject + main verb (in many cases). For questions without auxiliary, use 'do/does/did'.
3. 'Who' and 'what' can be used as subjects (no auxiliary then).
4. 'How' often combines with adjectives/adverbs: 'How long', 'How often', 'How many'.
5. Use polite forms: 'Could you tell me where...' for indirect questions.

Examples:

- Who wrote this?
- Where are you going?
- How long have you been studying English?
- Why did they leave early?

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. _____ did you arrive? (When/Where)
2. _____ is your brother? (Who/What)
3. _____ are the keys? (Where/Who)
4. _____ did she say that? (Why/How)
5. _____ book is this? (Whose/Who)
6. _____ does it cost? (How much/What)
7. _____ many students passed? (How/What)
8. _____ did they finish the project? (When)
9. _____ is she studying? (What/Who)
10. _____ are you doing this for? (Why/Where)
11. _____ did you see at the park? (Whom/Who)
12. _____ did they leave? (When/Why)

13. _____ you came late? (Why/Did)
14. _____ is the train expected to arrive? (When/How)
15. _____ subject are you good at? (Which/Who)
16. _____ is the capital of France? (What/Who)
17. _____ often do you exercise? (How/Why)
18. _____ does she look so happy? (Why/How)
19. _____ is the tallest building here? (What/Which)
20. _____ of the two is better? (Which/Who)

1. When
2. Who
3. Where
4. Why
5. Whose
6. How much
7. How
8. When
9. What
10. Why
11. Whom / Who
12. When / Why
13. Why did
14. When
15. Which
16. What
17. How
18. Why

Answers (Suggested):

19. Which
20. Which

Frequency Adverbs

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Frequency adverbs (always, usually, often, sometimes, rarely, seldom, never) indicate how often an action occurs.
2. Place frequency adverbs before the main verb (I often go) but after 'to be' (She is always punctual).
3. Adverb position can change meaning: 'usually' before main verb vs at the start for emphasis.
4. Use quantifiers like 'every day', 'twice a week' for specific frequencies.

Examples:

- She always arrives early.
- I usually have cereal for breakfast.
- He is often late.
- They rarely go to the cinema.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. She _____ (always) forgets her keys.
2. I _____ (never) eat meat.
3. They _____ (usually) arrive by 8. (position)
4. He is _____ (often) tired after work.
5. We go on holiday _____ (once/twice a year).
6. She _____ (seldom) calls me.
7. I _____ (sometimes) read before bed.
8. He _____ (rarely) drinks coffee.
9. Do you _____ go jogging? (often/sometimes)
10. They _____ arrive late. (frequently)
11. I _____ study on Sundays. (usually) 12. She _____ visits her grandparents. (often)
13. We _____ (never) miss the train.

14. He _____ (occasionally) goes shopping.
15. The children _____ play outside. (sometimes)
16. She _____ takes the bus. (usually)
17. I _____ forget birthdays. (rarely)
18. They _____ phone in the evening. (always/often)
19. He _____ arrives early for meetings. (usually)
20. Do you _____ swim? (often/seldom)

Answers (Suggested):

1. always
2. never
3. usually
4. often
5. once / twice a year
6. seldom
7. sometimes
8. rarely
9. often / sometimes
10. frequently
11. usually
12. often
13. never
14. occasionally
15. sometimes
16. usually
17. rarely
18. always / often
19. usually

20. often / seldom

Adjectives & Adverbs

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Adjectives modify nouns; adverbs modify verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs.
2. Many adverbs are formed by adding '-ly' to adjectives (quick → quickly), but some are irregular (good → well).
3. Adjective order (opinion-size-age-shape-color-origin-material-purpose) governs multiple adjectives before a noun.
4. Position: adjectives usually before the noun or after linking verbs; adverbs have flexible positions depending on emphasis.

Examples:

- A quick runner (adjective).
- She runs quickly (adverb).
- He is a very good student (adverb modifying adjective).
- The bright, red car (adjective order).

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. Change to adverb: She is a slow runner → She runs _____.
2. Adjective or adverb? She looks _____ (happy/happily).
3. Form adverb: quick → _____
4. Correct: He did the work careful → He did the work _____.
5. Adjective order: a _____ (big / red) ball.
6. Choose: She sings _____ (beautiful/beautifully).
7. He becomes _____ (quiet/quietly). (after linking verb)
8. The _____ (tall / young) man walked in.
9. Modify adjective: very + good → very _____.
10. Adverb placement: She _____ (always) arrives on time.
11. Form adverb: happy → _____
12. Use adverb: Drive _____ (careful/carefully).
13. Adjective vs adverb: He feels _____ (bad/badly).

14. Make adverb: loud → _____
15. Combine: She is a _____ (talented / young) artist.
16. Choose correct: He answered _____ (quick/quickly).
17. She looks extremely _____ (beautiful/beautifully).
18. Adverb modifying adverb: very + quickly → very _____.
19. Form: easy → _____
20. Adjective after noun: The man is _____ (tall).

Answers (Suggested):

1. slowly
2. happy (adjective after linking verb)
3. quickly
4. carefully
5. big red
6. beautifully
7. quiet
8. tall young
9. good
10. always
11. happily
12. carefully
13. bad
14. loudly
15. talented young
16. quickly
17. beautiful
18. quickly
19. easily

20. tall

Reported Speech

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Reported (indirect) speech conveys what someone said without quoting them directly. Tense, pronouns, and time/place expressions often change.
2. Back shifting: Present → Past (e.g., 'She says: "I am ill"' → He said (that) she was ill).
3. Change of pronouns and time expressions (today → that day, here → there, tomorrow → the next day).
4. Questions change structure: Wh-questions keep the wh-word; yes/no questions use 'if/whether'.

Imperatives use 'asked/ordered + to + verb'.

5. If the reporting verb is in present, backshift may not be necessary.

Examples:

- Direct: He said, 'I am tired.' → Reported: He said (that) he was tired.
- Direct: 'Where are you going?' → Reported: She asked where I was going.
- Direct: 'Close the door,' → Reported: He asked me to close the door.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. She said, 'I will come.' → Reported: She said that _____.
2. He said, 'I am hungry.' → Reported: He said that _____.
3. 'Where do you live?' she asked. → Reported: She asked _____.
4. 'Will you help me?' he asked. → Reported: He asked _____.
5. 'Don't make noise,' she said. → Reported: She told us _____.
6. 'I have finished it,' he said. → Reported: He said that _____.
7. 'I can swim,' she said. → Reported: She said that _____.
8. 'I'll call you tomorrow,' he said. → Reported: He said he _____ call me _____.
9. 'Are you coming?' she asked. → Reported: She asked _____.
10. 'What is your name?' he asked. → Reported: He asked _____.

11. 'Close the window,' he ordered. → Reported: He ordered us _____.
12. 'I may be late,' she said. → Reported: She said that _____.
13. 'I have been there,' he said. → Reported: He said that _____.
14. 'Why did you do that?' she asked. → Reported: She asked _____.
15. 'Please help me,' he pleaded. → Reported: He begged _____.
16. 'I will not go,' she said. → Reported: She said that _____.
17. 'Have you finished?' he asked. → Reported: He asked _____.
18. 'Where is the station?' she asked. → Reported: She asked _____.
19. 'I might come,' he said. → Reported: He said that _____.
20. 'Why are you late?' she asked. → Reported: She asked _____.

Answers (Suggested):

1. she would come
2. he was hungry
3. where I lived
4. if/whether I would help him
5. not to make noise
6. he had finished it
7. she could swim
8. would, the next day
9. if/whether I was coming
10. what my name was
11. to close the window
12. she might be late
13. he had been there
14. why I had done that
15. to help him

16. she would not go
17. if I had finished
18. where the station was
19. he might come
20. why I was late

Conditional Sentences

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Zero conditional: general truths — If + present simple, ... present simple (If you heat water, it boils).
2. First conditional (possible future): If + present simple, ... will + base verb (If it rains, I will stay home). 3. Second conditional (unreal present): If + past simple, ... would + base verb (If I won the lottery, I would travel).
4. Third conditional (unreal past): If + past perfect, ... would have + past participle (If I had studied, I would have passed).
5. Mixed conditionals and inversion for formal style are advanced uses.

Examples:

- If you heat ice, it melts. (zero)
- If it rains, we'll cancel the picnic. (first)
- If I were rich, I would buy a house. (second)
- If she had known, she would have told us. (third)

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. If you _____ (heat) water, it _____ (boil). (zero)
2. If it _____ (rain), we _____ (stay) inside. (first)
3. If I _____ (have) time, I _____ (help). (second)
4. If she _____ (study), she _____ (pass). (third)
5. If he _____ earlier, he _____ the bus. (catch - first/second)
6. If they _____ more careful, they _____ fewer mistakes. (be - second)
7. If I _____ known, I _____ helped. (third)
8. If you heat metal, it _____ (expand). (zero)
9. If I were you, I _____ (not do) that. (second)
10. If she _____ faster, she _____ the race. (run)
11. If they _____ the clues, they _____ solved it. (see)

12. If I _____ the answer, I _____ tell you. (know)
13. If it _____ sunny, we _____ picnic. (be - first)
14. If he _____ rich, he _____ donate more. (be - second)
15. If you _____ the instructions, you _____ success. (follow - first)
16. If we _____ earlier, we _____ caught. (leave - third)
17. If she _____ the truth, she _____ angry. (know - first)
18. If you _____ now, you _____ help. (come)
19. If they _____ honest, they _____ trusted. (be)
20. If I _____ a teacher, I _____ explain more. (be)

Answers (Suggested):

1. heat / boils
2. rains / will stay
3. had / would help
4. had studied / would have passed
5. catches / would catch
6. were / would make
7. had / would have
8. expands
9. wouldn't do
10. runs / will win
11. had seen / would have
12. knew / would
13. is / will have
14. were / would
15. follow / will find
16. had left / would have been

17. knows / will be
18. come / will
19. are / will be
20. were / would

Passive Voice

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. In passive voice the object of an active sentence becomes the subject of the passive sentence: Subject + be + past participle (+ by agent).
2. Tense of 'be' matches the tense of the active verb; use past participle of main verb.
3. Agent ('by...') is optional and often omitted if unknown or unimportant.
4. Use passive to emphasize the action or the receiver, not the doer.

Examples:

- Active: The chef cooked the meal. → Passive: The meal was cooked (by the chef).
- Active: People speak English worldwide. → Passive: English is spoken worldwide.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. Change to passive: The teacher praises the student.
2. Change to passive: Someone has stolen my bike.
3. Change to passive: They will finish the project.
4. Change to passive: He wrote the letter.
5. Change to passive: The company employs many people.
6. Change to passive: People speak Spanish in Spain.
7. Change to passive: They are building a new bridge.
8. Change to passive: The mechanic repaired the car.
9. Change to passive: Someone has answered the question.
10. Change to passive: They will announce the results tomorrow.
11. Change to passive: People believe him.
12. Change to passive: She had completed the work.
13. Change to passive: They make cars in that factory.
14. Change to passive: We must solve this problem.

15. Change to passive: They can finish the job.
16. Change to passive: People are repairing the roads.
17. Change to passive: Someone will tell him.
18. Change to passive: They had made a decision.
19. Change to passive: The police have arrested the suspect.
20. Change to passive: You should not ignore the rules.

Answers (Suggested):

1. The student is praised by the teacher.
2. My bike has been stolen.
3. The project will be finished (by them).
4. The letter was written by him.
5. Many people are employed by the company.
6. Spanish is spoken in Spain.
7. A new bridge is being built.
8. The car was repaired by the mechanic.
9. The question has been answered.
10. The results will be announced tomorrow.
11. He is believed.
12. The work had been completed by her.
13. Cars are made in that factory.
14. This problem must be solved.
15. The job can be finished (by them).
16. The roads are being repaired.
17. He will be told.
18. A decision had been made.
19. The suspect has been arrested.
20. The rules should not be ignored.

Future Tenses & Prepositions

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Future forms: 'will' (decisions, predictions), 'be going to' (planned intent), present continuous for scheduled events, simple present for timetables.
2. Future perfect and continuous express completed actions by a future time and ongoing actions respectively.
3. Prepositions (in, on, at, by, for, since, to, into) indicate time, place, movement, cause, and agent; their correct use depends on context.
4. Time prepositions: 'at' for clock times, 'on' for days/dates, 'in' for months/years/longer periods.

Examples:

- I will call you tomorrow.
- I am going to study tonight.
- The train leaves at 9:00.
- She will have finished by next week.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. Choose: I _____ (will / am going to) visit him next week.
2. Fill preposition: She will arrive _____ Monday. (on/at/in)
3. Future continuous: At 5 pm I _____ (watch) TV.
4. Use present continuous (plan): We _____ (leave) on Friday.
5. Future perfect: By 2025, I _____ (graduate).
6. Preposition: The meeting is _____ 3 pm. (at/on/in)
7. Preposition for months: My birthday is _____ May. (in/on/at)
8. Use 'by': Finish it _____ Friday. (by/on)
9. Preposition of movement: She walked _____ the room. (into/in/to)
10. Time phrase: I will see you _____ noon. (at/in/on)
11. Planned future: He _____ (is going to) start a job.

12. Present simple for timetable: The plane _____ (leave) at 6.
13. Preposition: He arrived _____ the airport. (at/in/on)
14. Future possibility: It _____ rain tomorrow. (might/will)
15. Preposition: She has lived here _____ 2010. (since/for)
16. Preposition: I studied _____ two hours. (for/since)
17. Future continuous: This time next week I _____ (travel).
18. Preposition: Put it _____ the table. (on/in/at)
19. Use 'by' or 'until': Finish it _____ Friday. (by/until)
20. Future planned: They _____ (are getting) married next year.

Answers (Suggested):

1. will / am going to (context)
2. on
3. will be watching
4. are leaving
5. will have graduated
6. at
7. in
8. by
9. into / into the room
10. at
11. is going to
12. leaves
13. at
14. might / will
15. since
16. for
17. will be travelling

18. on
19. by
20. are getting

Advanced Connectives

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Advanced connectives include conjunctive adverbs and phrases: nevertheless, however, moreover, furthermore, consequently, as a result, in contrast, on the other hand.
2. They are used for sophisticated linking in essays and formal writing; punctuation (semicolon or period) is often required before them.
3. Use them to show contrast, emphasis, result, addition, concession, and comparison.
4. Be cautious not to overuse; ensure logical connection.

Examples:

- She was tired; nevertheless, she finished the work.
- Moreover, the study confirms previous results.
- Consequently, the policy was revised.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. Fill: He failed the exam; _____, he studied hard. (however/nevertheless)
2. Use: _____ the rain, the match continued. (Despite/In spite of)
3. Choose: The system failed; _____, tests continue. (nevertheless)
4. Use: The report is late; _____, it is useful. (however)
5. Connect: The plan was risky; _____, we agreed. (nevertheless)
6. Result: She didn't study; _____, she passed. (surprisingly/consequently)
7. Addition: The book is short; _____, it's informative. (moreover)
8. Concession: _____ his efforts, he did not succeed. (Despite)
9. Comparison: On the other hand is used for _____. (contrast)
10. Use: The data is clear; _____, more research is needed. (however)
11. Use phrase: As a result, _____. (show consequence)

12. Fill: He was late; _____, the meeting started without him. (therefore)
13. Use: _____ the complexity, the solution worked. (Despite/In spite of)
14. Link: She loves music; _____, she dislikes concerts. (however)
15. Connector: The team worked; _____, the plan failed. (nevertheless)
16. Transition: _____ the above, we conclude. (In light of)
17. Emphasis: It is important; _____, note the results. (moreover)
18. Contrast: He prefers coffee; _____, she prefers tea. (on the other hand)
19. Formality: Use 'furthermore' to add _____. (information)
20. Cause-effect: The machine broke; _____, production stopped. (therefore)

Answers (Suggested):

1. however / nevertheless
2. Despite / In spite of
3. nevertheless
4. however
5. nevertheless
6. surprisingly / consequently
7. moreover
8. Despite
9. contrast
10. however
11. consequence/result
12. therefore
13. Despite / In spite of

14. however
15. nevertheless
16. In light of
17. moreover
18. on the other hand
19. information
20. therefore

Miscellaneous Agreements

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Miscellaneous agreement topics include pronoun-antecedent agreement, number agreement after fractions/percentages, and agreement with expressions like 'the number of' vs 'a number of'.
2. 'A number of' + plural → take plural verb. 'The number of' + singular → takes singular verb.
3. Pronouns (each/every) take singular pronouns; 'they' is commonly used colloquially but formal writing prefers singular pronouns.

Examples:

- A number of students are absent.
- The number of applicants is increasing.
- Each student must bring his or her book.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. A number of people _____ (be) present.
2. The number of complaints _____ increasing. (be)
3. Each of the boys _____ finished. (has/have)
4. Half of the cake _____ gone. (is/are)
5. Sixty percent of the work _____ complete. (is/are)
6. None of the answers _____ correct. (is/are)
7. Every student _____ required to attend. (is/are)
8. Both of them _____ guilty. (is/are)
9. One-third of the pie _____ eaten. (has/have)
10. Neither the manager nor the employees _____ ready. (is/are)
11. Many a man _____ tried. (has/have)
12. Each participant _____ a certificate. (receive/receives)
13. No one _____ here. (is/are)
14. All of the milk _____ spoiled. (is/are)
15. Some of the information _____ missing. (is/are)

16. Ten percent of the students _____ passed. (has/have)
17. Two thirds of the cake _____ eaten. (has/have)
18. Every one of the books _____ valuable. (is/are)
19. Most of the work _____ finished. (is/are)
20. Either of the plans _____ acceptable. (is/are)

Answers (Suggested):

1. are
2. is
3. has
4. is
5. is
6. is / are (context)
7. is
8. are
9. has
10. are
11. has
12. receives
13. is
14. is
15. is
16. have
17. has
18. is
19. is
20. is

Relative Clauses

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Relative clauses (who, whom, whose, which, that) provide extra information about a noun. They can be defining (restrictive) or non-defining (non-restrictive).
2. Defining clauses identify the noun and do not use commas; non-defining add extra info and use commas.
3. 'Who' for people, 'which' for things, 'that' can be used for people or things in defining clauses; 'whom' is object form.
4. Possessive 'whose' and omission of the relative pronoun (in informal English) are advanced usages.

Examples:

- The man who called is my uncle. (defining)
- My brother, who lives in Australia, is a doctor. (non-

defining) - The book that you lent me was great.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. Use relative: The woman _____ helped me is kind. (who/which)
2. Combine: The car is old. It broke down. → The car _____ broke down is old. (that/which)
3. Non-defining: My sister, _____ is a lawyer, visited. (who)
4. Which / that: The house _____ I bought is new. (that/which)
5. Whose: The boy _____ bike was stolen is crying. (whose)
6. Whom: The man _____ I met was helpful. (whom/who)
7. Omit pronoun: The film (that) we saw was thrilling.
8. Use 'which' for things: The cup _____ broke was expensive. (which)
9. Defining: Students _____ study hard succeed. (who)
10. Non-defining commas: My car, _____ I bought last year, is red. (which)

11. Relative time: That was the day _____ we met. (when)
12. Relative place: This is the town _____ I grew up. (where)
13. Combine persons: The doctor _____ treated me was kind. (who)
14. Use 'which' for ideas: The idea _____ she proposed was novel. (which)
15. Who/that: The player _____ scored is injured. (who/that)
16. Add clause: The book, _____ cover is red, is mine. (whose) 17. Which vs who: The teacher _____ teaches us is strict. (who)
18. Omit: The article (that) I read was helpful.
19. Use whom: To _____ did you give it? (whom)
20. Combine: Students _____ pass will get certificate. (who)

Answers (Suggested):

1. who
2. that / which
3. who
4. that / which
5. whose
6. whom / who
7. (that)
8. which
9. who
10. which
11. when
12. where
13. who
14. which
15. who / that

16. whose
17. who
18. (that)
19. whom
20. who

Past Tenses

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Past Simple: completed actions at a definite past time (I walked).
2. Past Continuous: background actions or simultaneous past actions (I was walking).
3. Past Perfect: action completed before another past action (I had eaten before he arrived).
4. Use time expressions (yesterday, last year, in 2000) and signal words for clarity. Sequence of past tenses matters.

Examples:

- I walked to the store yesterday.
- She was studying when I called.
- They had left before the party started.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. Fill: I _____ (go) to the market yesterday. (went)
2. Past continuous: While I _____ (sleep), the phone rang. (was sleeping)
3. Past perfect: She _____ (finish) before he arrived. (had finished)
4. Change: I ate when he _____ (come). (come→came)
5. Fill: They _____ (play) football at 3 pm. (were playing)
6. Sequence: By the time we arrived, they _____ (leave). (had left)
7. Use past simple: He _____ (win) the match last week.
8. Use past continuous: It _____ (rain) when I left.
9. Fill: She _____ (not/attend) the meeting yesterday.
10. Past perfect continuous: They _____ (work) for hours before stopping. (had been working)
11. Change to past: 'I am tired' → He said he _____ (was)
12. Fill: We _____ (visit) Paris in 2019.
13. Use time phrase: Last year she _____ (graduate).

14. Past simple negative: He _____ (not/like) the food.
15. Interruption: I _____ (read) when she came. (was reading)
16. Past perfect use: After he _____ (finish), he left. (had finished)
17. Fill: They _____ (be) friends since childhood. (were)
18. Question in past: _____ you see him yesterday? (Did)
19. Fill: She _____ (break) her arm last month. (broke)
20. Story: I _____ (wake) up late and missed the bus. (woke)

Answers (Suggested):

1. went
2. was sleeping
3. had finished
4. came
5. were playing
6. had left
7. won
8. was raining
9. did not attend / didn't attend
10. had been working
11. was
12. visited
13. graduated
14. did not like / didn't like
15. was reading
16. had finished
17. were
18. Did
19. broke

20. woke

Advanced Prepositions

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. Advanced prepositions and prepositional phrases: in front of, in spite of, due to, owing to, according to, as well as, along with.
2. Some prepositions require noun phrases: 'interested in', 'good at', 'responsible for'.
3. Collocations: learn verbs + preposition combinations (depend on, look after, insist on).
4. Prepositions of time/place/movement are context-sensitive.

Examples:

- In spite of the rain, they went out.
- Due to heavy traffic, we were late.
- She is good at maths.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. Fill: He is good _____ math. (at/in)
2. Use: In spite _____ the cold, we walked. (of)
3. Choose: Due _____ the delay, we left early. (to)
4. Collocation: depend _____ (on/of)
5. Preposition: according _____ the law, it is illegal. (to)
6. Phrase: along _____ the river. (with)
7. Complete: She insisted _____ paying. (on)
8. Use: He is responsible _____ the accounts. (for)
9. Fill: They are interested _____ music. (in)
10. Phrase: owing _____ illness, he left. (to)
11. Preposition: He walked _____ the room. (into/onto/through)
12. Choose: according _____ recent studies. (to)
13. Phrase: as well _____ (as) someone else
14. Collocation: look _____ (after/for)
15. Use: She apologized _____ being late. (for)

16. Preposition: The book is _____ the shelf. (on/in/at)
17. Fill: He is married _____ a doctor. (to)
18. Phrase: in front _____ the house. (of)
19. Choose: take care _____ (of)
20. Complete: according _____ experts, ... (to)

Answers (Suggested):

1. at
2. of
3. to
4. on
5. to
6. with
7. on
8. for
9. in
10. to
11. into / through
12. to
13. as
14. after
15. for
16. on
17. to
18. of
19. of
20. to

Would / Used to

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. 'Used to' refers to past habits or states that no longer occur: 'I used to swim.'
2. 'Would' describes repeated past actions (habits) but not past states: 'When we were kids, we would play outside.'
3. 'Would' is also used for polite requests and conditional results. 'Used to' cannot be used in negative questions as easily without auxiliary: 'Didn't you use to...?' or 'used n't you' (archaic).

Examples:

- I used to go there every summer.
- When we were young, we would spend hours playing.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. I _____ (used to/use to) play football as a child.
2. When I was a kid, we _____ (would/used to) visit my grandparents.
3. She _____ (used to) live in London but now lives in Delhi.
4. Would as polite: _____ you help me? (would/could)
5. Negative: He didn't _____ smoke. (use to)
6. Habit: We _____ (used to) go fishing every weekend.
7. State: I _____ want a pet when I was young. (used to)
8. Would for past habit: On Sundays we _____ (would) have a family meal.
9. Question: _____ you used to play cricket? (Did)
10. Contrast: She used to be shy; now she _____ outgoing. (is)
11. Use in conditional: I would help if I _____ (could).
12. Use: He would often call me at night. (habit)
13. Form: She _____ (used to) be vegetarian.
14. Negative question: Didn't you _____ (use to) like apples?

15. Would for preference: I would rather stay. (would)
16. Used to for state: He _____ (used to) own a bike.
17. Would for past repeated action: She _____ (would) bring gifts.
18. Use to vs used to: I _____ (use to/used to) climb trees.
19. Would for future in past: He said he _____ come later. (would)
20. Used to negative: She _____ (not used to) eat meat.

Answers (Suggested):

1. used to
2. would / used to
3. used to
4. Would / Could
5. use to / used to
6. used to
7. used to
8. would
9. Did
10. is
11. could
12. would
13. used to
14. use to
15. would
16. used to
17. would
18. used to
19. would
20. didn't use to / didn't used to (informal)

Adjective Order

Rule and explanation (step-by-step):

1. When multiple adjectives modify a noun, English prefers a typical order: opinion, size, age, shape, color, origin, material, purpose.
2. Native-like order: 'a lovely (opinion) small (size) old (age) round (shape) red (color) Italian (origin) wooden (material) table (purpose)'.
3. Not all categories are used; use as many as are natural.

Examples:

- A beautiful large old round wooden table (opinion-size-age-shape-material).
- An expensive black leather jacket.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. Order: (big / red) ball → a _____ ball.
2. Order: (beautiful / old / small) painting → a _____ painting.
3. Make correct: She bought a leather new black jacket. → a _____ jacket.
4. Choose: a _____ (tiny / lovely) kitten.
5. Arrange: (wooden / round / old) table → a _____ table.
6. Form: an _____ (ancient / magnificent) statue.
7. Order: (Italian / delicious) pizza → a _____ pizza.
8. Combine: a _____ (quiet / small / modern) room.
9. Adjective pile: She has a _____ (beautiful / new / small) ring.
10. Correct the order: He has a red big car → a _____ car.
11. Arrange: (round / shiny / metal) clock → a _____ clock.
12. Order: (old / massive / stone) building → a _____ building.
13. Form: a _____ (bright / smart) student.
14. Arrange: (comfortable / leather) sofa → a _____ sofa.
15. Combine: a _____ (tiny / old / wooden) box.
16. Choice: a _____ (lovely / blue) dress.

17. Arrange: (delicious / homemade) cake → a _____ cake.
18. Order: (ancient / Greek) vase → an _____ vase.
19. Form: a _____ (new / innovative) device.
20. Arrange: (small / round / golden) locket → a _____ locket.

Answers (Suggested):

1. big red
2. beautiful small old
3. new black leather
4. lovely tiny
5. old round wooden
6. magnificent ancient
7. delicious Italian
8. quiet small modern
9. beautiful new small10. big red
11. shiny round metal
12. massive old stone
13. bright smart
14. comfortable leather
15. tiny old wooden
16. lovely blue
17. delicious homemade
18. ancient Greek
19. new innovative
20. small round golden

Mixed Practice Exercises

Mixed practice: These exercises combine multiple grammar topics (question tags, modals, tenses, passive, reported speech, connectives, relative clauses, prepositions, and more).
Approach: Read carefully, identify the grammar focus, and apply the appropriate rules step-by-step. Use the reference sections above for guidance.

Examples:

- Combine: He said, 'I will have finished it.' → Reported: He said that he would have finished it.
- Combine tense and preposition: By 2023 he will have been working here for five years.

Practice Exercises (Questions):

1. Correct the error: She don't like apples.
2. Fill: If I _____ (be) you, I would apologize. (were)
3. Tag: You're coming, _____?
4. Passive: People speak English here. → _____ English here.
5. Reported: 'I can swim,' she said. → She said she _____ swim.
6. Preposition: He arrived _____ 3 pm. (at)
7. Modal: You _____ see a doctor. (should)
8. Relative: The man _____ lives next door is a teacher. (who)
9. Tense: I _____ (already finish) my homework when she called. (had already finished)
10. Adverb position: She _____ (always) forgets. (always)
11. Determiner: _____ students must register. (All/Every)
12. Connective: She failed; _____, she tried hard. (however/nevertheless)
13. Question word: _____ did you do that? (Why)
14. Agreement: None of them _____ ready. (is/are)

15. Future: I _____ (be) there by noon. (will be)
16. Used to: I _____ (used to) play tennis.
17. Adjective order: (small / lovely) house → a _____ house.
18. Advanced preposition: He left _____ the meeting. (during/after)
19. Form passive: They have canceled the show. → The show _____ canceled.
20. Reported question: 'Where are you going?' → He asked _____.

Answers (Suggested):

1. She doesn't like apples.
2. were
3. aren't you?
4. English is spoken here.
5. could
6. at
7. should
8. who
9. had already finished
10. always
11. All / Every
12. however / nevertheless
13. Why
14. are / is (context)
15. will be
16. used to
17. lovely small
18. during / after (context)
19. has been / was canceled (context)

20. where I was going

Final Notes & Forward-Looking Study Tips

1. Practice deliberately: mix focused grammar drills with real reading/listening to see forms in context.
2. Spaced repetition: revisit difficult topics at increasing intervals for long-term retention.
3. Apply grammar in writing: keep a grammar journal and correct mistakes using grammar rules.
4. Teach someone else: explaining rules deepens your command of them.
5. Use targeted tests: after each topic, do a timed quiz to measure improvement.